

Question 24 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Explain career planning and potential appraisal as HRD subsystems.

Answer

Career planning and potential appraisal look forward. They develop people for tomorrow's roles, complementing performance appraisal which looks mainly at yesterday and today.

- 1. Potential appraisal – meaning:** Systematic judgement of an employee's capability to take up higher or different responsibilities, using tools such as review discussions, assessment centres, and psychological tests where appropriate.
- 2. Purpose:** Identify talent, avoid promoting only on current-job performance (the 'Peter Principle' risk), and guide development investments.
- 3. Career planning – meaning:** A joint process of mapping possible paths (vertical, lateral, specialist) and the experiences/skills needed.
- 4. Individual side:** Helps employees understand options, aspirations and development actions.
- 5. Organisational side:** Ensures succession, reduces vacancy risk, and aligns talent with strategy.
- 6. Interrelation:** Potential data inform career moves; career plans specify training, job rotation and mentoring.
- 7. Counselling link:** Career counselling prevents unrealistic expectations and frustration.
- 8. HRD contribution:** Together they institutionalise long-term employee development rather than ad-hoc promotions.

Conclusion. *Career planning and potential appraisal are therefore forward-looking HRD subsystems that build a talent pipeline and meaningful employee growth.*